HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

OVER THREE DECADES as a trader, strategist, and asset manager, I have been sharing my thoughts about markets in public and in real time. I wanted to organize those ideas and experiences into something *especially* useful for other investors.

Finding a useful structure was the first task: Between *The Washington Post*, Bloomberg, and TheStreet.com, I have written nearly 1,000 columns on money and investing. Add in 43,158 posts published at The Big Picture as of December 31, 2024, and that useful structure proved elusive.

After my last vacation, I was sifting through all these columns and blog posts, and a pattern emerged: I'll be damned if every other piece wasn't debunking some piece of investment bullshit[3] or another. Since the 1990s, dissecting behavioral errors and revealing money myths has been the heart of my work. If only investors could ignore the doomsayers, forget the predictions, steer clear of Wall Street, lose unreliable sources of information, and skip listening to their brother-in-law's stock tips, they would all be better off.

My list of investing **"Nos"** went on and on: Avoid pricey products, steer clear of most SPACs and IPOs, understand your portfolio (why *do you* own commodities?), be skeptical of active managers. You can't even trust your own brain—it wasn't built for this, and more often than not, it will fool you into making mistakes that will lose you money.

As I plowed through the list of DON'TS, the structure of the book revealed itself: *How Not To Invest.* A simple guide to avoiding the myths, mistakes, and errors investors make all the time.

Despite how much we have learned over the past century about capital markets and risk, about human nature and our behavior, too many people still do quite poorly when it comes to investing.